

Concept Artist & Game-Art
PORTFOLIO

Jacob Leitch

2025-2026



INTRODUCTION

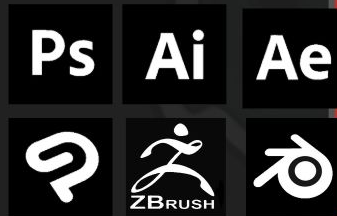
Hello there!

I'm Jacob Leitch, a concept artist and aspiring game artist with a strong focus on visual development, creature design, and world-building. I'm particularly interested in how design, form, and storytelling come together in games. This portfolio highlights both my technical foundations and my creative process.

Experience

- ◆ **Commissioned Concept Artist**
|September 2017 - Present
- ◆ **Movie Poster Painter**
- Big Cat Film Company
|May 2021 - August 2021
- ◆ **Concept-Artist, 3D-Designer,
Costume & Prop Fabricator**
- PropTown Fabrication
|November 2020 - October 2021

Software



Contact

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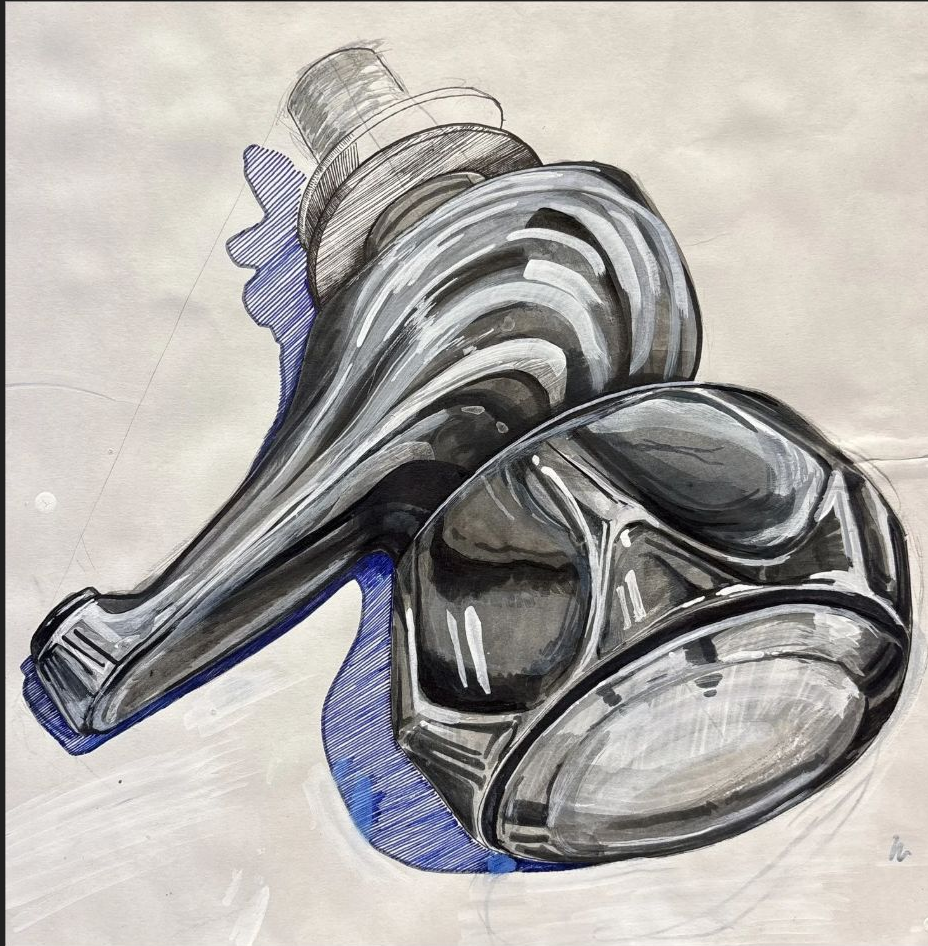


CONTENTS

- 1 FUNDAMENTALS & OBSERVATIONAL STUDIES
- 2 COMPOSITION & LIFE DRAWING
- 3 CHARACTER DESIGN & COSTUME ITERATION
- 4 CREATURE & WORLD DESIGN
- 5 PROFESSIONAL & CROSS-DISCIPLINARY WORK



1 FUNDAMENTALS & OBSERVATIONAL STUDIES



TIMED LIFE STUDY: KITCHEN TAP

35 minutes

Tools used:

- ◆ Fine Liner
- ◆ Thick Marker
- ◆ Pencil
- ◆ Blue Ink
- ◆ White Indian Ink
- ◆ Watered down black Ink

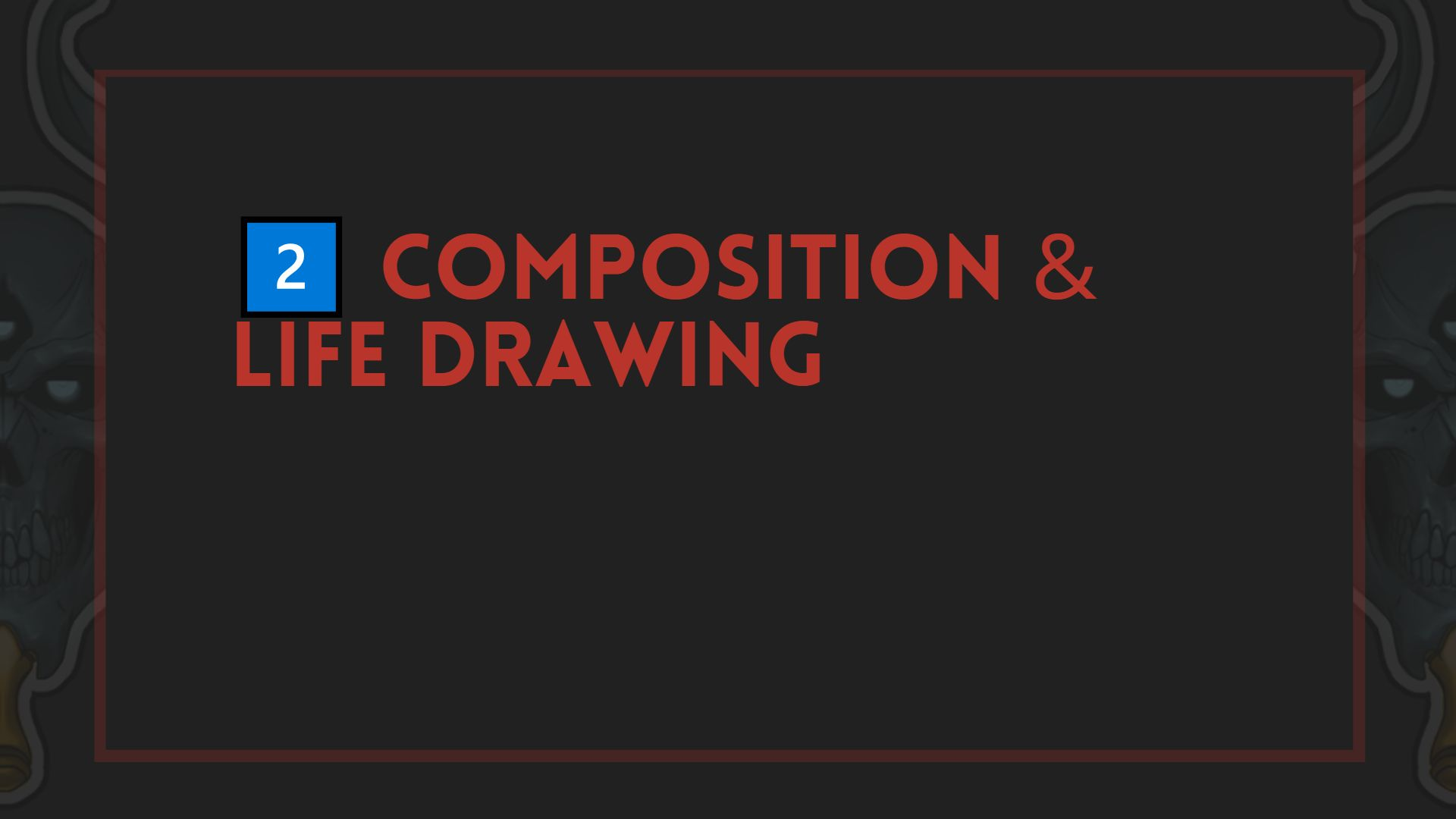
TIMED LIFE STUDY: STABLE BRUSH

1 Hour, 30 minutes

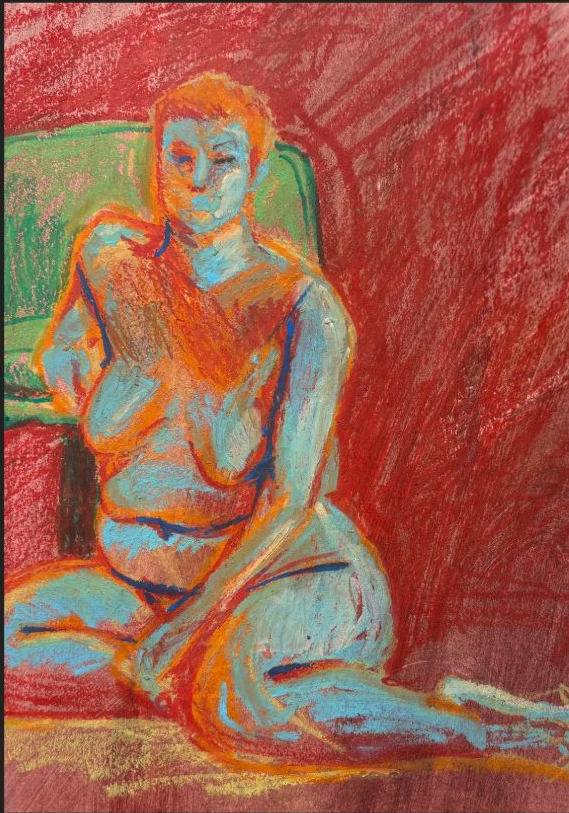
Tools used:

- ◆ Fine Liner
- ◆ pen
- ◆ Pencil
- ◆ graphite
- ◆ White Indian Ink
- ◆ marker



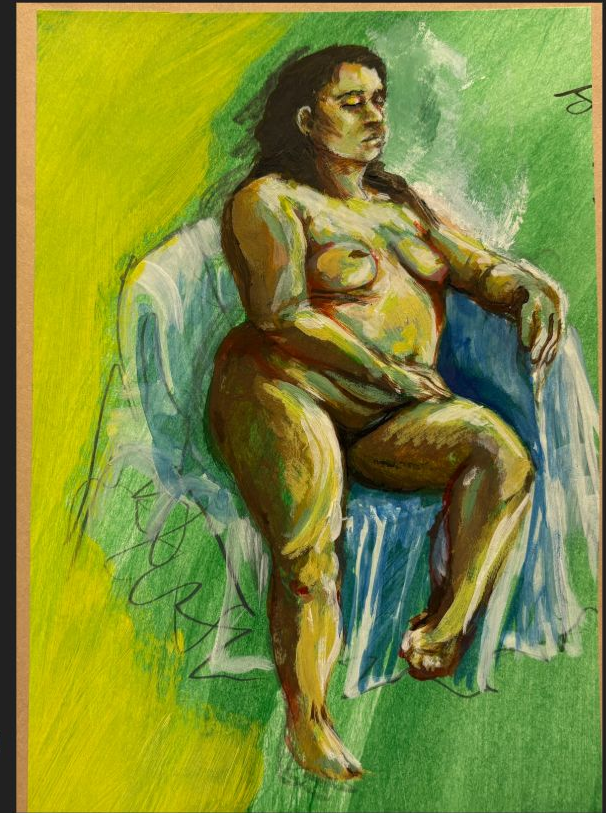
The background features a dark, charcoal grey surface. On the left and right sides, there are faint, stylized illustrations of human skulls. The skulls are rendered in a light grey or off-white color, showing the eye sockets, nasal cavities, and upper jaw areas. A prominent red rectangular frame is centered on the page, enclosing the main title text.

2 COMPOSITION & LIFE DRAWING



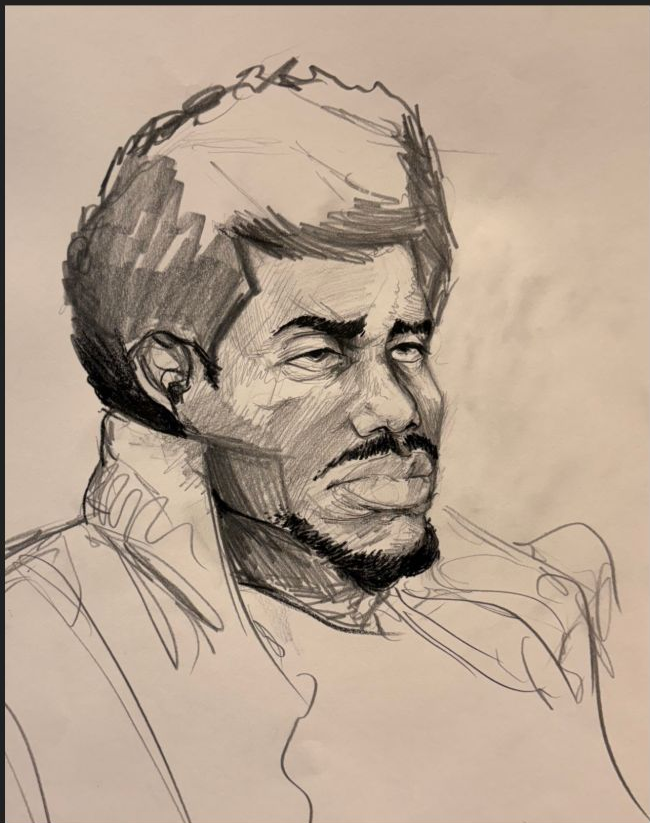
25 minutes
tools used:
 ◆ pencil
 ◆ Pastel

Expressive life drawing focusing on gesture, colour, and simplified form. Hard use of non-paint mediums and shortened time to get form.



30 minutes
tools used:
 ◆ pencil
 ◆ Watered-down
 Acrylic paint

Observational figure study focusing on anatomy, weight, and proportion. the use of heavily watered down acrylic, mixed with an understanding of skin colour theory to get realistic enough colour in a short time span



15 minutes

tools used:

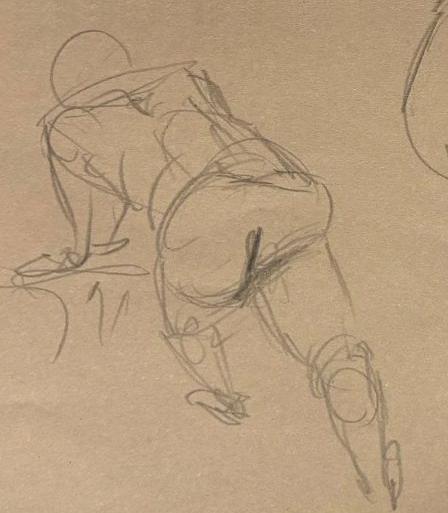
- ◆ Graphite
- ◆ black crayon



15 minutes

tools used:

- ◆ Graphite
- ◆ watered down black ink



3 minutes
tools used:
◆ Pencil



5 minutes
tools used:
◆ watered down
◆ Acrylic paint



3 minutes
tools used:
◆ Graphite
◆ Pencil



5 minutes
tools used:
◆ watered down
◆ Acrylic paint



40 minutes

tools used:

- ◆ Graphite
- ◆ pencil crayon
- ◆ pencil



35 minutes

tools used:

- ◆ Graphite
- ◆ pencil crayon
- ◆ pencil



33 minutes

tools used:

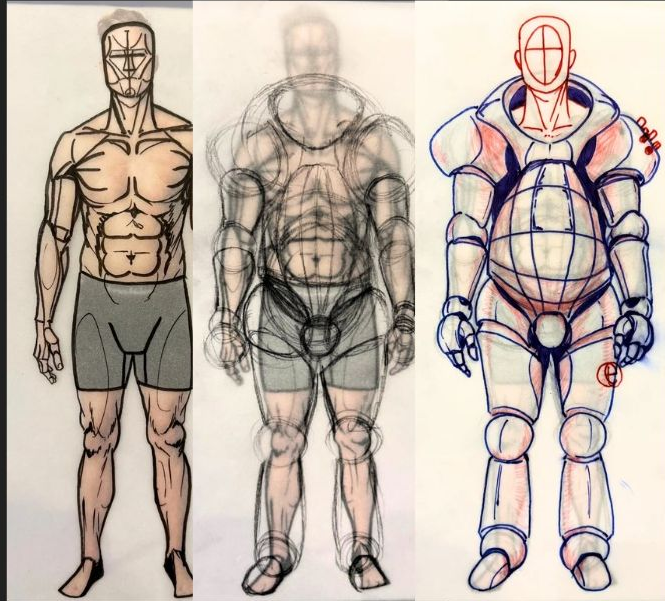
◆ Acrylic paint



3 CHARACTER DESIGN & COSTUME ITERATION

COSTUME DESIGN ITERATION

DESIGN BRIEF: DESIGN
A CAR YOU CAN WEAR.



1



2

1 The Methodology I took to my initial design was to make the streamline chrome of a classic car wearable. A smooth rounded form that interlocks and fits perfectly together.

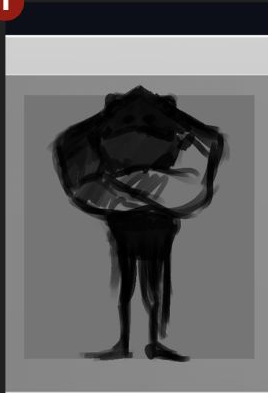
2 The second design, in complete opposite to the first design is based off of the undercarriage of a car. Each section of the car having an analogous correlation to its placement on the figures form.

like the first design, all the parts fit together, with the potential movement of the wearer. But, unlike the first the design, this one features in prominence, a mess of jagged forms, despite its overall harmony.

SILHOUETTE BLOCKING

DESIGN BRIEF: HIGH SEAS ANIMALS

1



Animal: Frog/Toad

- 1 Silhouette study exploring exaggerated proportions and mass to create a strong, instantly recognizable character shape.
- ◆ **Construction:** Rounded edges and square shapes
- ◆ **Idea:** Brawler/Bodyguard

2



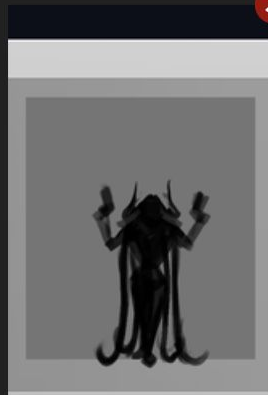
Animal: Coyote

- 2 Silhouette exploration focusing on a short, readable profile and strong negative space to convey a clear character role and hierarchy.
- ◆ **Construction:** Sharp edges and triangles
- ◆ **Idea:** Gunslinger/Kung-Fu artist wielding a staff

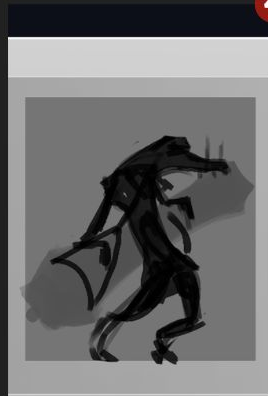
Animal: Sheep/Ram

- 3 Silhouette blocking focused on pose and gesture to communicate personality and emotion without internal detail.
- ◆ **Construction:** Sharp edges, triangles, and subtle use of rounded forms
- ◆ **Idea:** Pirate captain

3



4

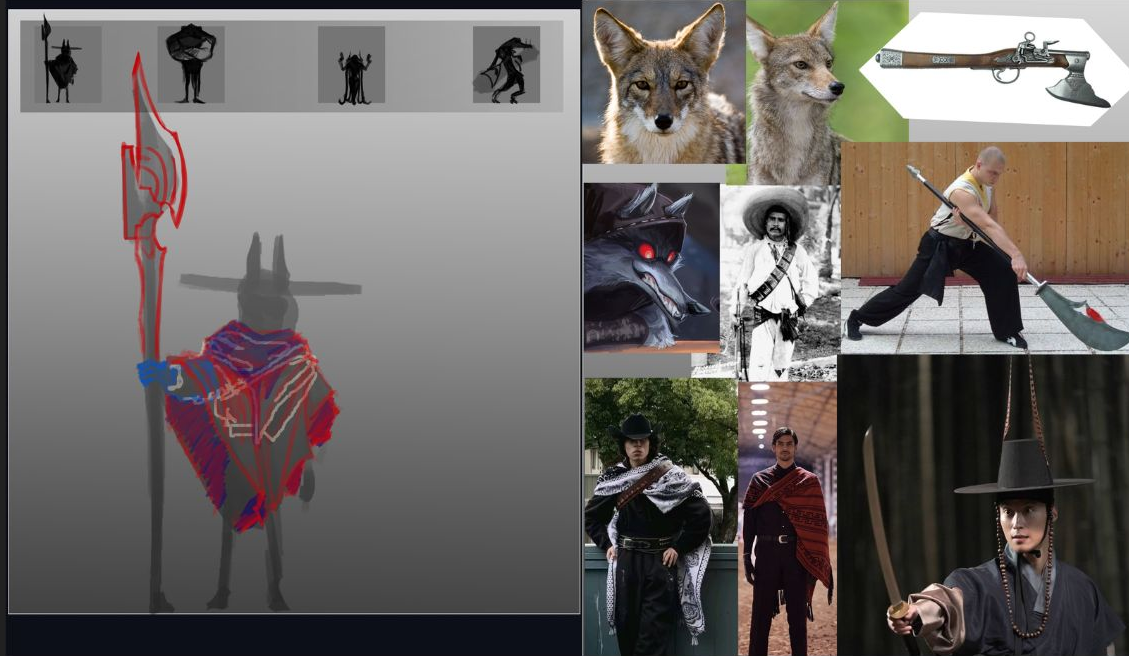


Animal: Crocodile

- 4 Character silhouette exploration emphasizing dynamic posture and asymmetry to suggest movement and threat.
- ◆ **Construction:** Sharp edges, boxes, and rounded forms
- ◆ **Idea:** heavy weapons user/Bandit

"Coyote Privateer – Shadow Blade Slinger" Coyote – Privateer Hire

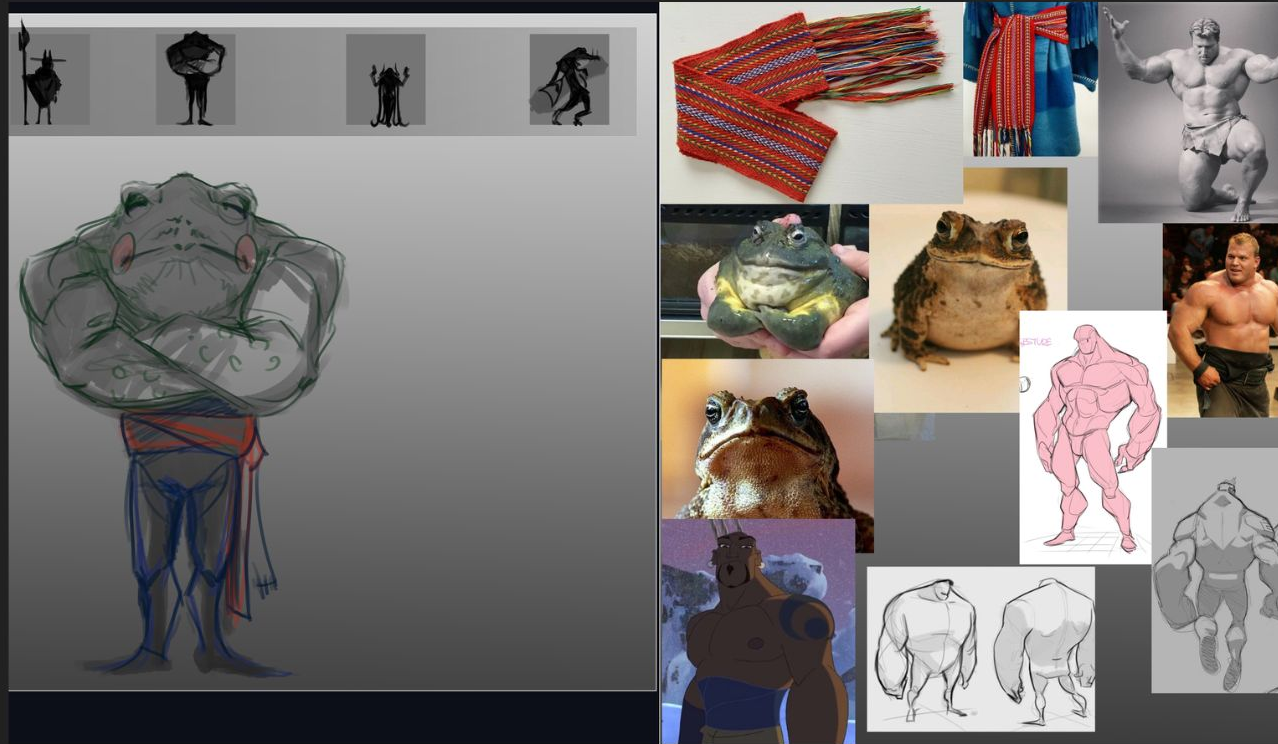
- ◆ A lean, opportunistic coyote hired on as muscle and makeshift quartermaster's aide. Blends martial artist precision (fluid kicks, claw strikes) with copyboy cunning — always scribbling manifests, maps, or blackmail notes while dodging blades in close-quarters brawls. Sly desert predator adapted to sea life: bandana mask, hidden daggers, and a grin that says he's already three steps ahead of any bounty hunter.



I used the reference images to guide different paths of the design, blending the rugged, sun-burnt feel of a cowboy with the controlled, ceremonial presence of a Kung-fu monk. The goal was to merge these influences into a single character while maintaining a clear silhouette and strong identity.

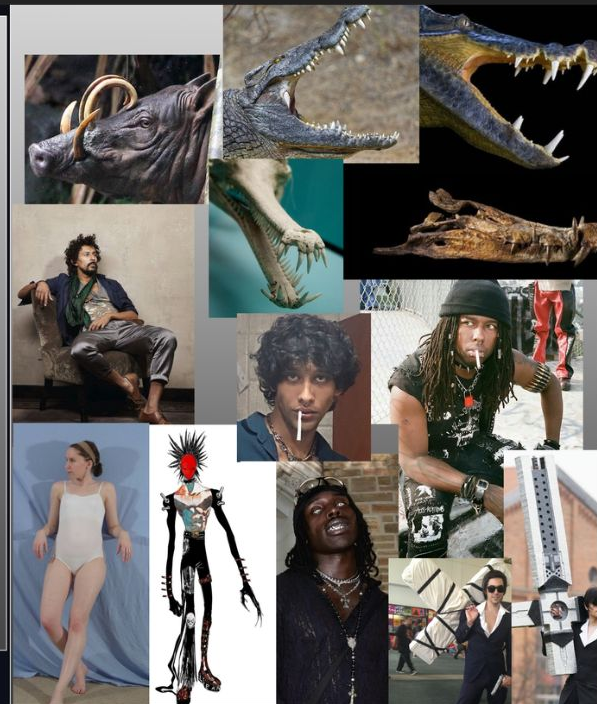
"Toad First Mate – Swamp Enforcer" **Toad – First Mate**

- ◆ The captain's unflinching right hand: a colossal, glistening toad whose massive frame and coiled muscle scream brute authority on deck. Real amphibian skin folds and swamp predator menace blend with pirate utility — rope belts, scarred hide from boarding hooks, and a low-center stance for holding the line in storms or mutinies. Loyal muscle with a croaking growl that keeps the crew in check.



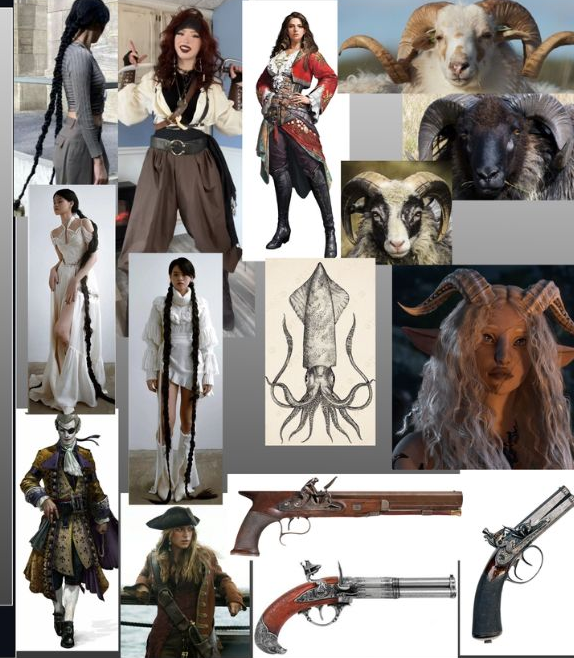
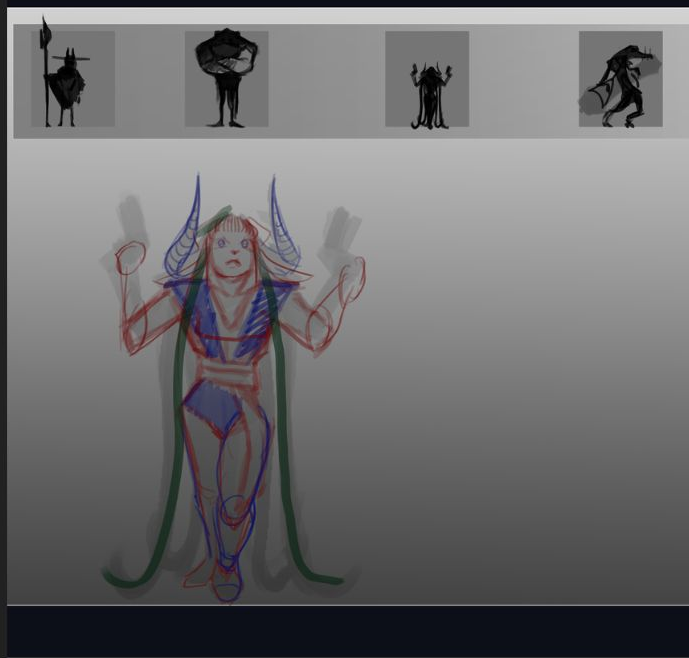
"Crocodile Enforcer - Smiling Death" **Crocodile - Heavy**

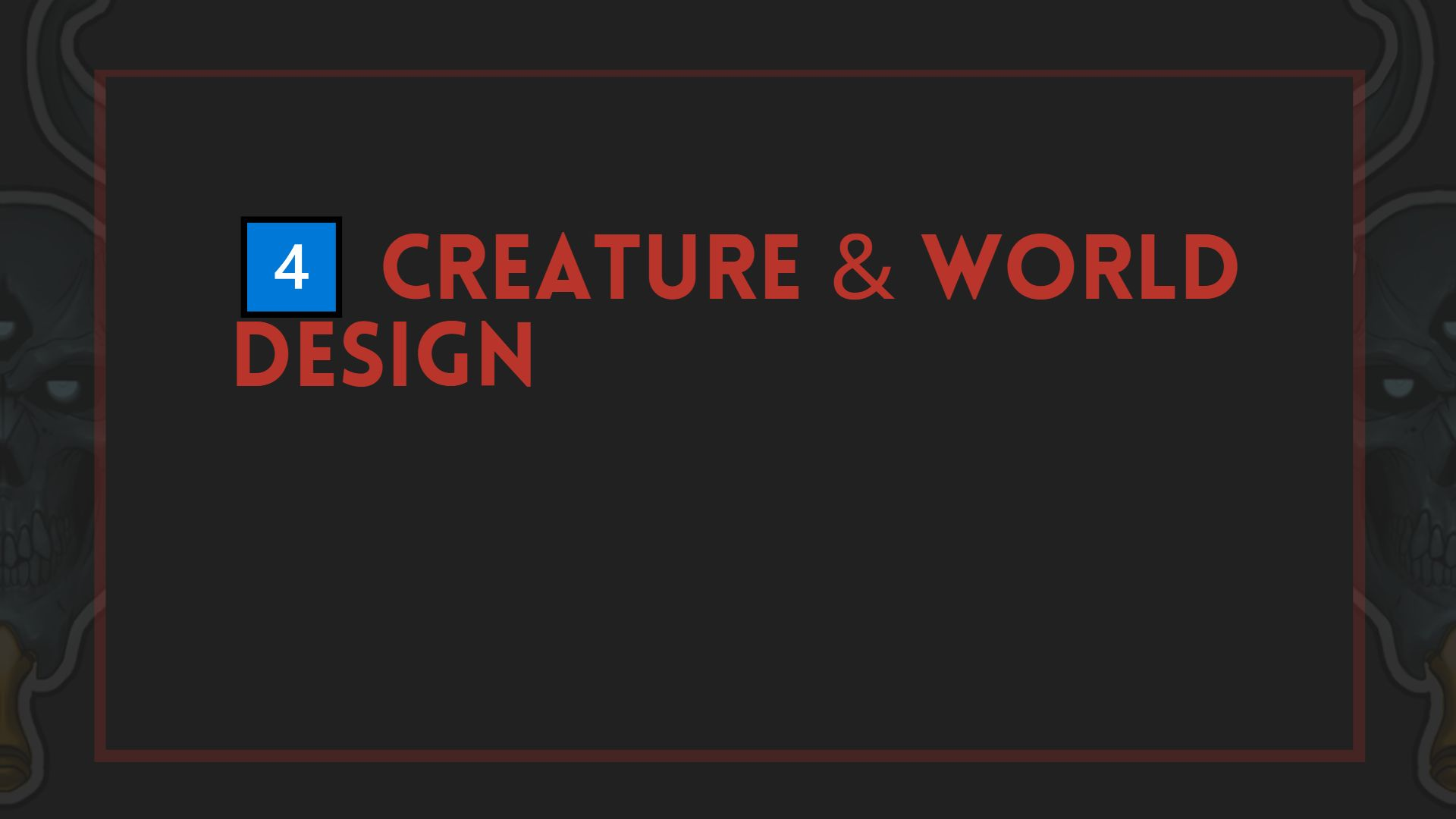
◆ The crew's resident "friendly" monster: a broad, armored crocodile who greets you with a toothy grin and a firm handshake — right before the jaws close. Exudes gangster danger — slow, deliberate movements, scarred scales from old knife fights, and an aura that makes even hardened sailors check their exits. Befriends you over rum, then reminds you why no one crosses the crew; perfect for intimidation, debt collection, and quiet betrayals at sea.



"Sheep Captain – Iron Fleece Sovereign" **Sheep – Captain**

- ◆ The hardened leader of the crew: a battle-scarred sheep whose curled ram horns and muscular build project unyielding command, yet a single soft ribbon in her wool hints at buried vulnerability or lost sentiment. Pirate lord through and through — tricorn tilted low, multiple arms (or tentacle-like sashes) wielding flintlocks and cutlasses, eyes that have seen too many sinkings. Rules with iron will and quiet menace; cross her, and the softness vanishes.





4 CREATURE & WORLD DESIGN

INVENTORY ITEM SPLASH ART – SOULSLIKE INSPIRED GAME: SYMPHONY OF BRASS

"Eye of a Baleful demon"



"Eye of an unlucky demon"



"A Coin with the weight of A Soul"



"A WytchFinder's Finger"



◆ These pieces were created as inventory item splash art for a game project, inspired by the presentation style seen in Dark Souls and Elden Ring. The focus was on producing highly readable, isolated assets that communicate mood, rarity, and narrative at a glance.

◆ I intentionally used restrained colour palettes, controlled lighting, and centered compositions to ensure each item feels grounded within the same visual language. The forms were designed to be immediately recognisable even at smaller UI scales, prioritising silhouette clarity and focal contrast over excessive detail. Each item also hints at its narrative function through subtle material choices and unsettling organic forms, supporting world-building without relying on explicit explanation.



"Eye of a Baleful demon"



- ◆ With both designs, (both being iterations of each other with teaks) the eye was supposed to give a "other-worldly" nature, and as it was described as almost as if the eye was deeply "unclean." Given that, I chose to give the eyes a black sclera, pulling heavily from primate eyes - to follow that line of familiar but uncanny. Secondly, I pulled a almost worm infested look language, for the optic nerves visible on the eyeball - giving an instinctful feeling to the viewer you wouldnt want to touch this thing.

"EYE OF A BALEFUL DEMON"

- ◆ Designed to feel ominous and powerful, this item uses a strong central glow and minimal surrounding detail to draw the eye immediately. The sharp contrast reinforces its dangerous, high-value nature within the inventory.
- ◆ Lore hook, item description; **"...Baleful hunger lingers, far after removal..."**

"EYE OF A BALEFUL DEMON"

- ◆ This variation explores how small changes in colour and light can suggest different narrative meaning. The warmer tones and less aggressive glow imply corruption rather than direct threat, allowing visual storytelling through subtle shifts.
In-game the item was ment to be a more "common" and less valuable version of the "Eye of a Baleful Demon."

- ◆ Lore hook, item description; **"...Sometimes, Demons loose at Cards..."**

- ◆ In the early versions of the design, the thought process was to have the cords of muscle and optical attachment be apart of the items design, but it soon became clear it distracted and ultimately made the design weaker, and was scrapped.

"Eye of an unlucky demon"



"YGGDRASIL – CORE OVERWORLD CHARACTER/NPC GAME SPRITES

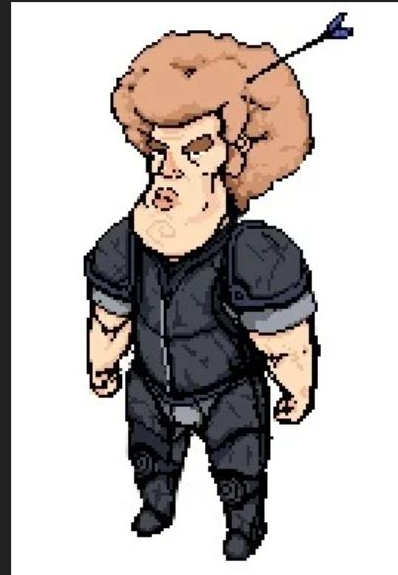


◆ "Yggdrasil" is a retro-inspired 2D game drawing from Norse mythology, where the colossal World Tree begins to rot from an ancient curse. Its once-vital sap turns toxic, twisting guardians into abominations and fracturing the nine realms. Players climb decaying branches, battle corrupted entities, and uncover the tree's betrayal. Choosing either to heal the rot, or embrace the end of the 9 worlds.

◆ Its Development Began during the summer of 2017, but never got out of pre-Alfa development, as the studios creatives left the project to pursue other projects.

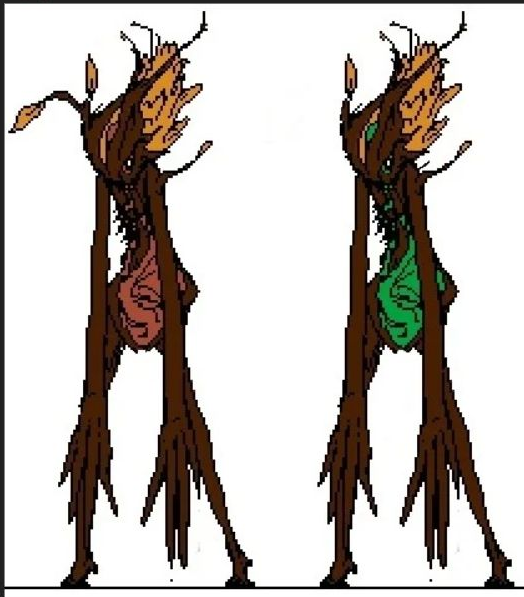
◆ During the games original development I was in charge of the character sprite work and designing the feel of the world, in collaboration with other members of the team.

◆ I designed and animated a suite of pixel sprites; corrupted elves, arrow-pierced warriors, rootborn horrors, and eldritch abominations. Emphasis on limited palettes, readable silhouettes, secondary motion (branch sway, pulsing corruption), and 8-12 fps cycles for gameplay fluidity.



CREATURE/ENEMY DESIGN

INITIAL PALLET



Process & Reflection

I started with broader tests (32+ colors) for aggressive energy; refined to ~16-color limit for retro pixel authenticity, performance in hordes, and cohesive game world. Iterations prioritized narrative support: warmer = "active rot," final = "long-festered menace." This evolution ensures sprites remain scannable in combat while reinforcing Yggdrasil's decay theme.

Desaturated earthy browns + sickly teal/cyan accents on exposed organs, veins, and glows—creates an "unhealthy, otherworldly" corruption feel.

Key Changes: Hue shift to cooler tones (brown → teal for rot emphasis), reduced overall saturation (~60-70% drop on mains), added subtle dither gradients for texture without extra colors.

Benefits: Enhances cosmic horror/entropy mood; improves readability in dark forest/root biomes; enables efficient animation (e.g., pulsing teal weak points for attack telegraphs at 8-12 fps without palette overflow).

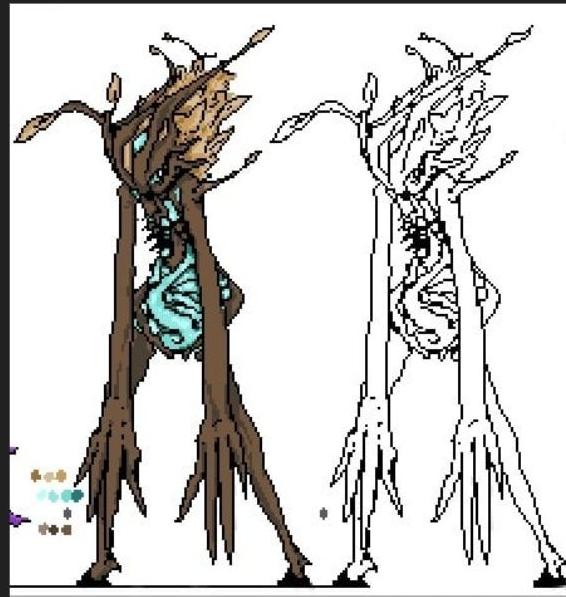
In-Game Fit: Warmer tones reserved for "recently corrupted" variants; final for boss-tier abominations—visually escalates the blight narrative.

Warmer browns, oranges, yellows, and reds for bark and flame-like energy—intended to convey immediate threat and "fresh corruption" in early encounters.

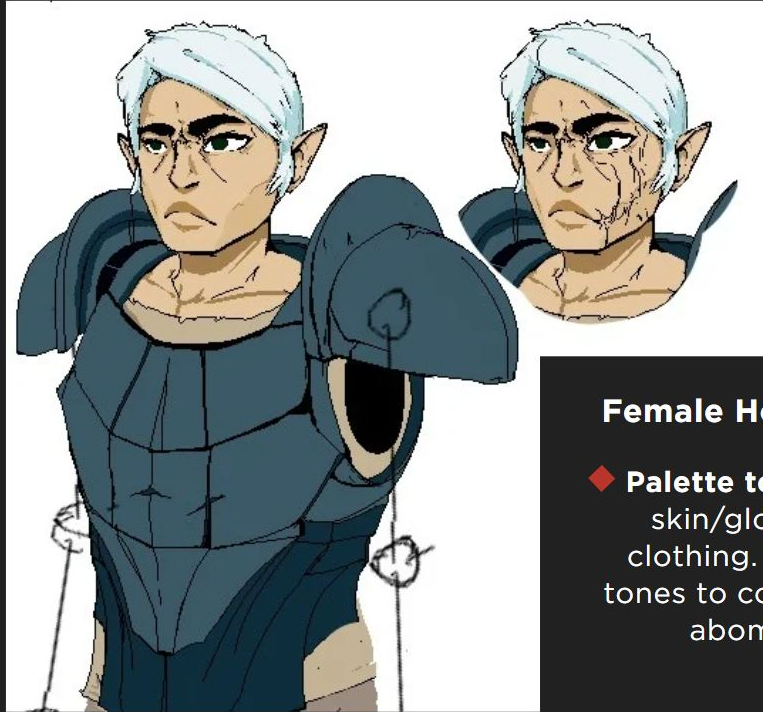
Pros: High contrast and visual pop in brighter upper biomes; strong silhouette against greens.

Cons: Too vibrant/alive for deeper blight themes; saturation clashed with desaturated world progression and player character palettes.

FINAL PALLET



NPC TALK SPRITES

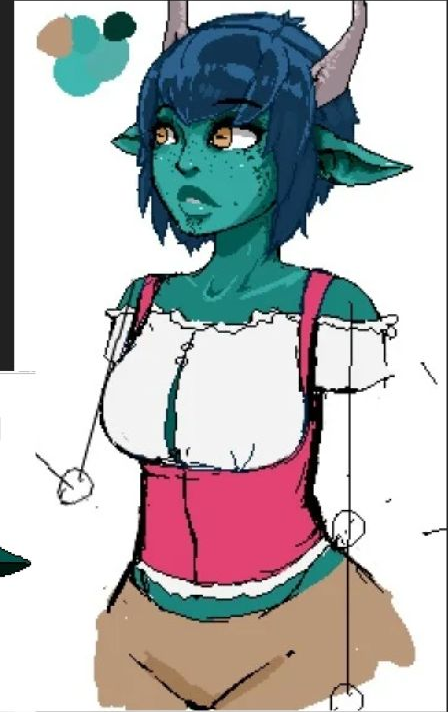


Male Elf Guard

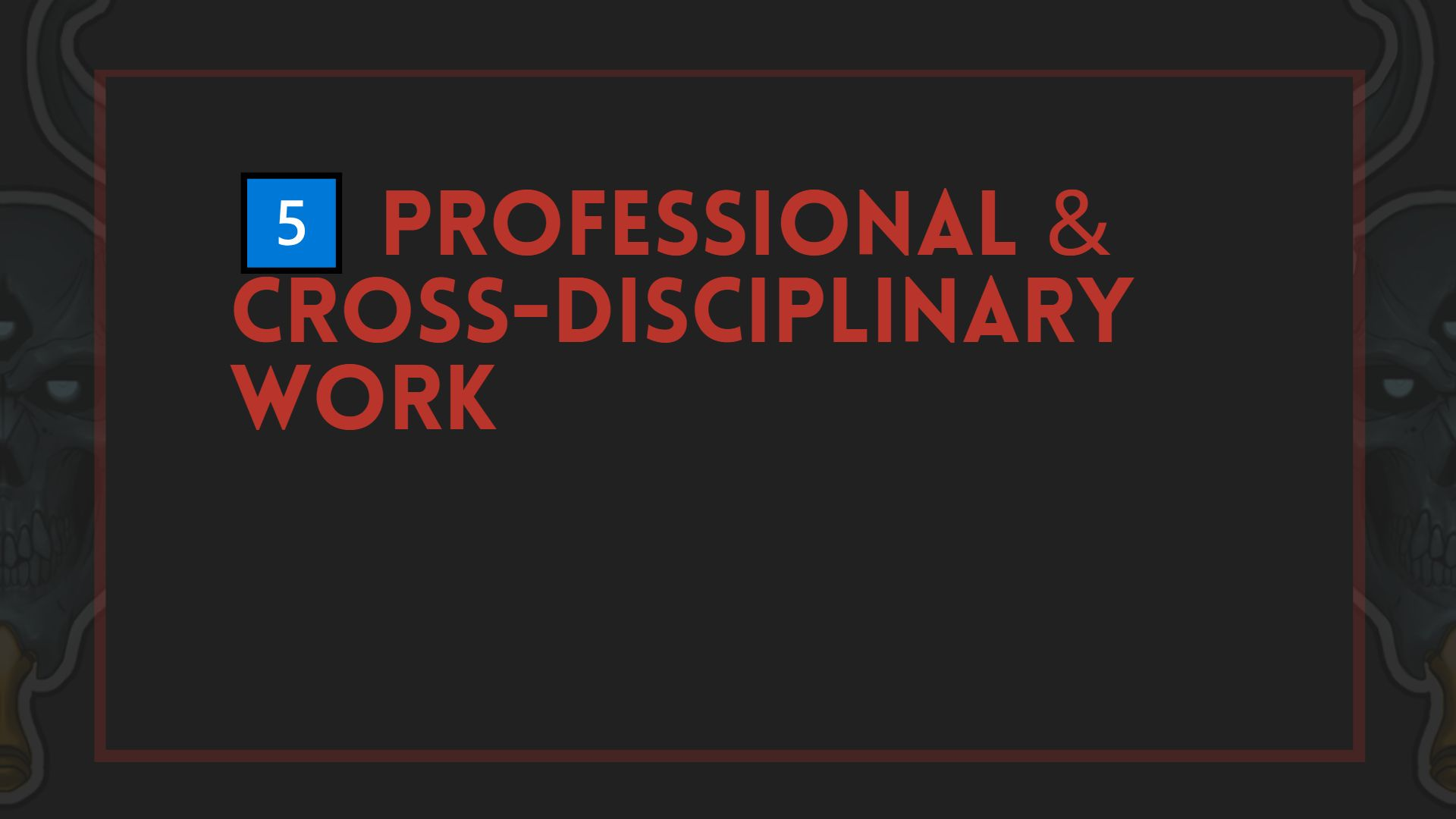
- ◆ Stoic base expression with Scarred alt face from later battle encounter, or storyline exposure to the blight.
- ◆ **Palette tests:** Cool teals/blues for "faded glory" armor, pale skin for the stereotypical uncorrupted elf look.

Female Horned Elf Town NPC

- ◆ **Palette tests:** Greens/teals for skin/glow, pinks/whites for clothing. Shifted from warmer tones to cooler for cohesion with abomination palettes.

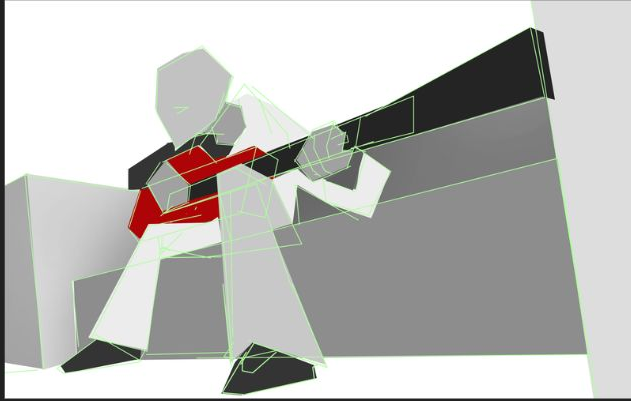


- ◆ These portraits serve as dynamic pop-up UI elements during NPC interactions in "Yggdrasil," overlaying dialogue text. Designed for retro pixel conversion, they feature corrupted elf NPCs/warriors. Exaggerated physical features ensure emotional readability in a 3rd person viewset.



5 PROFESSIONAL & CROSS-DISCIPLINARY WORK

CLIENT COMMISSION - LENNY KRAVITZ



- ◆ This piece was commissioned by a client putting together a short form documentary on YouTube, about the artist. The piece took 1 hour, and was recorded for the client and sped up as B-Roll for their video,

CLIENT COMMISSION - DND MINDFLAYER



- ◆ This piece took 6 hours in total to paint both digitally and traditionally.

◆ This piece was commissioned by a client looking to have a flashy splash art for their Dnd campaign.

◆ The original thumb sketch was developed in acrylic paint, before being finished in Digital media, after client approval.



CLIENT COMMISSION - BALROG PAINTING



- ◆ The Client for this work wanted both a painted and digital product for their purchase.
- ◆ To maintain the similarity and make a noticeable distinctiveness between the two versions, I finished the physical painting first and the digitally altered the style.
- ◆ The original painting took a huge amount of inspiration from classical Tolkien artists like John Howe.
- ◆ Oppose to this, the digital version was only, enhanced, but with the Balrog fully repainted. This was to make its design, to be more reminiscent to the Balrog seen in the films

This piece took 26 hours in total to paint both digitally and traditionally.



CLIENT COMMISSION - PSIONIC BEHOLDER



- ◆ This piece was commissioned by a client looking for something very similar to that of the Mindflayer piece. The commissioner was looking for a splash art image for their campaign to intimidate their players.
- ◆ The concept went through several traditional thumb paintings, trying to mix different design elements classically associated with the Beholder, and “psionics,” to create a instantly readable design.

PERSONAL PIECES • GREAT GREEN DRAGON



- ◆ This piece took 4 hours in total to paint digitally.

- ◆ This digital painting of a great Green dragon started out as a colour theory experiment. Using a limited pallet (green and blue), and (yellow, and orange), seeing if I could render an image that could stand as complete and believable on its own merit.
- ◆ While this Image did start out as an experiment in colour theory, its undoubtably some of my best work and one of my favourites.

PERSONAL PIECES • RED DRAGON IN CHASE



- ◆ This image ultimately was simply a design experiment, trying to iron out several hard to grasp colour, design, and perspective concepts. The ability to depict something so massive that its body fades with the blue of the atmosphere was a tricky task.

- ◆ This piece took 6 hours in total to paint digitally.



THANK YOU!

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